

ERICA

Heath

ERICACEAE

See also HEATHERS.

Genus of c. 800 species of evergreen subshrubs, shrubs and small trees with usually small, needle-shaped or oblong leaves, grown for their funnel-, bell- or urn-shaped to round or tubular flowers. Most require acidic, well-drained soil, but species have a wide range of preferences from wet and peaty to hot, sandy soil. They tolerate fire; seeds germinate best after a fire.

E. andevalensis. Twiggy, erect shrub. H to 6ft (2m), 5 to 26in (65cm). Produces narrow, ovate, mid-green leaves in whorls of 4 or 5, and umbels of urn-shaped, pink, or white flowers from late summer to fall. Needs well-drained soil. Z6–10. **‘Blanco de Odiel’** has white flowers.

E. arborea (Tree heath). Upright shrub or treelike heath. H 20ft (6m), 5 ft (1.5m). Liable to damage from frost and cold winds. Has needlelike, bright green leaves in whorls of 3 or 4 and bears scented, bell-shaped, white flowers from late winter to late spring. May tolerate slightly alkaline soil. Z9–10. **‘Albert’s Gold’**, H 6ft (2m), retains its golden foliage year-round.

‘Alpina’ (syn. *E.a.* var. *alpina*; illus. p.166) has vivid green foliage and compact racemes of white flowers. May be pruned hard to keep its shape and to encourage new growth. **var. alpina** see *E.a.* ‘Alpina’.

E. australis (Spanish heath). Erect shrub. H to 7ft (2.2m), 5 3ft (1m). Stems may be damaged by snow and wind. Has needlelike leaves in whorls of 4 and tubular to bell-shaped, white or purplish-pink flowers, mostly in clusters of 4, in spring. May tolerate slightly alkaline soil. Z9–10. **f. albiflora ‘Mr. Robert’** has white flowers. **‘Riverslea’** has bright purple-pink flowers.

E. baccans (Berry heath). Erect shrub. H to 6ft (2m), 5 3ft (1m). Light green leaves are needle-shaped, in whorls of 4. Bears profuse, small, pink, almost globular flowers in whorls of 4 at shoot tips in spring; sepals are distinctly keeled. Requires well-drained, acidic soil. Z8–11

E. canaliculata (Channeled heath). Erect shrub. H to 10ft (3m), 5 3ft (1m). Produces dark green, needle-shaped leaves in whorls of 3. Small, cup-shaped, pink or white flowers, with dark brown, almost black anthers, are borne in winter (under glass) or early spring (in the open). Requires acidic soil. Z9–10

E. carnea, syn. *E. herbacea* (Alpine heath, Winter heath). Spreading shrub. H to 1ft (30cm), 5 to 18in (45cm) or more. Produces needlelike, mid- to dark green leaves. Bell-shaped to tubular, pink, mauve, or white flowers, usually with prominent, colored sepals, open from early winter to late spring. Tolerates lime and some shade. Provides good groundcover. Z5–7.

‘Adrienne Duncan’ has dark green foliage tinged with bronze, and purple-pink flowers from midwinter to midspring.

‘Ann Sparkes’ (illus. p.166), H 6in (15cm), has golden foliage, turning to bronze in winter, and produces rose-pink flowers.

‘Cecilia M. Beale’, H 6in (15cm), bears

leaves are divided into ovate leaflets that are tinted reddish-purple. Z5–9.

‘Neosulfureum’ illus. p.262.

E. x warleyense illus. p.263.

E. x youngianum ‘Niveum’ illus. p.254.

EPIPHYLLUM

Orchid cactus

CACTACEAE

Genus of mostly epiphytic, perennial cacti with strap-shaped, flattened, green stems that have notched edges. Flowers are produced at notches. Frost tender. Grow in sun or partial shade and in rich, well-drained soil. Propagate by stem cuttings in spring or summer.

E. ackermannii. See *Disocactus ackermannii*.

E. anguliger (Fishbone cactus) illus. p.494.

E. crenatum. Erect, then pendent, semiepiphytic cactus. H and 5 10ft (3m). Has a flattened stem. Produces lightly perfumed, funnel-shaped, broad-petaled, white flowers, 8in (20cm) across, in spring–summer. Often used as a parent for breeding. Z11–12 (min. 50–59°F/10–15°C)

E. laui illus. p.482.

E. oxypetalum. Erect, then pendent, epiphytic cactus. H 10ft (3m), 5 3ft (1m). Produces freely branching, flattened stems, 5in (12cm) across. In spring–summer, bears nocturnal, tubular, white flowers, 10in (25cm) long. A good houseplant. Z11–12 (min. 50–59°F/10–15°C)

EPIPREMNUM

ARACEAE

Genus of evergreen, woody-stemmed, root-clinging climbers, grown for their handsome leaves. Frost tender. Grow in light shade away from direct sun; any well-drained, moisture-retentive soil is suitable. Water regularly, less in cold weather. Stems need good supports. Remove shoot tips to induce branching at any time. Propagate by leaf-bud or stem-tip cuttings in late spring or by layering in summer.

Ⓢ All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested, and contact with the sap of *E. aureum* may irritate skin.

E. aureum ‘Marble Queen’, syn. *E. pinnatum* ‘Aureum’ of gardens, *Scindapsus aureus* ‘Marble Queen’ (Devil’s ivy), illus. p.460.

E. pictum ‘Argyraeum’. See *Scindapsus pictus* ‘Argyraeus’.

E. pinnatum ‘Aureum’ of gardens. See *E. aureum* ‘Marble Queen’.

EPISCIA

syn. ALSOBIA

Carpet plant, Flame violet

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of evergreen, low-growing and creeping, epiphytic or terrestrial, stoloniferous perennials, grown for their ornamental leaves and colorful flowers. Useful as groundcover or in hanging baskets. Frost tender. Requires high humidity, a shaded site and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Keep well watered, but avoid waterlogging. Propagate in summer by stem cuttings, division or removing rooted runners.

E. cupreata (Flame violet) illus. p.471.

‘Metallica’ is an evergreen, creeping perennial. H 4in (10cm), 5 indefinite. Has ovate, downy, wrinkled leaves, tinged pink to copper and with broad, silvery bands along midribs. Funnel-shaped, orange-red flowers, marked yellow within, are borne intermittently. **‘Tropical Topaz’** has yellow flowers and pale green leaves. Z14–15 (min. 59°F/15°C)

E. dianthiflora, syn. *Alsobia dianthiflora* (Lace flower), illus. p.465.

E. lilacina. Evergreen, low-growing, terrestrial or epiphytic perennial, with runners bearing plantlets. H 4in (10cm), 5 indefinite. Has ovate, hairy, pale green leaves, to 3in (8cm) long. Bears funnel-shaped, white flowers, tinged mauve and with yellow eyes, in small clusters from fall to spring. Z11–12. (min. 59°F/15°C) Leaves of **‘Cuprea’** are bronze-tinged.

EPITHELANTHA

CACTACEAE

Genus of very slow-growing, spherical, perennial cacti densely covered with very short spines. Frost tender. Needs full sun and well-drained soil; prone to rotting if overwatered. Propagate by grafting, seed or stem cuttings in spring or summer.

E. micromeris illus. p.493.

ERAGROSTIS

Love grass

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

E. curvula ‘Totnes Burgundy’ illus. p.285.

ERANTHEMUM

ACANTHACEAE

Genus of woody-based perennials and evergreen shrubs, grown for their flowers. Frost tender. Requires full light or partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Water containerized plants freely when in full growth, moderately at other times. In spring or after flowering, remove at least half of each spent flowering stem to encourage a bushier habit. Propagate by softwood cuttings in late spring. Whitefly may be a nuisance.

E. atropurpureum. See *Pseuderanthemum atropurpureum*.

E. nervosum. See *E. pulchellum*.

E. pulchellum, syn. *E. nervosum* (Blue sage). Evergreen, erect shrub. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), 5 2ft (60cm) or more. Has elliptic to ovate, prominently veined, deep green leaves. Bears blue flowers, each with a 1¼in (3cm) long tube and rounded petal lobes, in winter–spring. Z13–15 (min. 55°F/13°C)

ERANTHIS

Winter aconite

RANUNCULACEAE

Genus of small clump-forming perennials, with knobby tubers, grown for their cup-shaped flowers surrounded by leaflike ruffs of bracts. Prefers partial shade and humus-rich soil, well-drained but not drying out excessively. Dies down in summer. Propagate by seed in fall or by division of clumps immediately after

flowering while still in leaf. Ⓢ All parts may cause mild stomach upset if ingested, and contact with the sap may irritate skin.

E. hyemalis (Winter aconite) illus. p.429.

Tubergenii Group ‘Guinea Gold’ (syn. *E. x tubergenii* ‘Guinea Gold’) is a late winter- or early spring-flowering, tuberous perennial. H 3–4in (8–10cm), 5 1½–2½in (4–6cm). Each stem bears a stalkless, deep golden-yellow flower, 1¼–1½in (3–4cm) across, surrounded by a bronze-green bract, cut into narrow lobes. Rounded leaves have finger-shaped lobes. Z4–9

E. x tubergenii ‘Guinea Gold’. See *E. hyemalis* Tubergenii Group ‘Guinea Gold’.

ERCILLA

PHYTOLACCACEAE

Genus of evergreen root climbers, grown for their neat, green leaves and green and purple flower spikes. Grow in sun or partial shade and in any well-drained soil. Prune after flowering, if required. Propagate by stem cuttings in late summer or fall.

E. spicata. See *E. volubilis*.

E. volubilis, syn. *Bridgesia spicata*, *E. spicata*, illus. p.192.

EREMURUS

Desert candle, Foxtail lily

ASPHODELACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of perennials with fleshy, fingerlike roots, grown for their stately spires of shallowly cup-shaped flowers in summer. Needs a sunny, warm position and well-drained soil. Tends to come into growth very early, and young shoots may be frosted. Cover with dry bracken in late winter to protect the crowns when shoots are first developing. Stake tall species and hybrids. Propagate by division in spring or early fall or by seed in fall.

E. himalaicus. Upright perennial. H 6–7ft (2–2m), 5 3ft (1m). Has strap-shaped, bright green basal leaves. In early summer, tall stems bear dense racemes of open cup-shaped, pure white blooms with long stamens. Z5–8

E. x isabellinus ‘Cleopatra’ illus. p.220.

Z5–8. **Shelford Hybrids** are perennials of varying habit and flower color. H 5ft (1.5m), 5 2ft (60cm). Long racemes of orange, buff, pink or white flowers are borne freely in midsummer. Leaves are strap-shaped, in basal rosettes.

E. robustus illus. p.216.

E. spectabilis. Erect perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), 5 2ft (60cm). Bears long racemes of pale yellow flowers, with brick-red anthers, in early summer. Leaves are strap-shaped, in basal rosettes. Z7–9

ERIA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.

E. coronaria, syn. *Trichosma suavis*. Evergreen, terrestrial or epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 9in (23cm). Sprays of fragrant, creamy-white flowers, ½in (1cm) across, with red- and yellow-marked lips, are borne in fall. Broadly ovate, glossy leaves, are 4in (10cm) long. Needs semishade in summer and moist compost year-round. Z6–8 (min. 50°F/10°C, max. 86°F/30°C)